CIPHER (QVYRA)

Developer Recruitment Package — June 2026

Core Protocol Architects Wanted

This document contains the GitHub issue text, recommended communities, and cold outreach template for finding the engineers Cipher needs. It is built around one essential rule: contributing does not create an entitlement to tokens, equity, governance rights or guaranteed return. Contributors may mine only after public launch under the same rules and with the same public information as everyone else.

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1. GitHub Issue Text

Title: Core Protocol Architects Wanted

Cipher: a sovereign proof-of-work currency for autonomous agents

Cipher is an early-stage open-source project exploring a sovereign Layer 1 currency designed for direct transactions between autonomous software agents and humans.

The intended protocol has no pre-mine, no founder allocation, no foundation, no protocol treasury, no governance token, no privileged validator set, no issuer capable of freezing or inflating transactions, proof-of-work issuance under publicly verifiable rules, privacy as a baseline design objective, non-custodial peer-to-peer settlement, a proposed Bitcoin to Cipher atomic-swap mechanism, and structural resistance to custodial exchange integration.

Cipher is currently a pre-protocol research and engineering project. There is no production blockchain, public testnet or completed consensus implementation. The whitepaper describes the intended direction, but several core decisions remain unresolved and must be made through open technical work.

We are looking for experienced engineers and researchers willing to challenge the design, help convert it into a formal specification, and determine whether its objectives can be implemented securely.

Areas Requiring Contributors

Distributed consensus and proof of work — proof-of-work consensus, chain selection and reorganisation handling, difficulty-adjustment algorithms, block and transaction validation, mempool design, peer-to-peer block propagation, fee markets and denial-of-service controls, early-chain and low-hashrate security, mining-pool decentralisation, adversarial consensus simulation. The proof-of-work algorithm, block interval, difficulty adjustment and launch-security model have not yet been selected.

Systems engineering in Rust or Go — network daemons, deterministic state machines, binary serialization, concurrent and asynchronous systems, reproducible builds, fuzz testing, property-based testing, profiling and resource limits, secure key handling. The initial objective is a minimal local implementation and private multi-node development network — not a premature public testnet.

Applied cryptography and private transactions — confidential transaction amounts, one-time or stealth transaction endpoints, interactive transaction construction, transaction aggregation and cut-through, sender and receiver unlinkability, supply auditability under confidential amounts, view keys and selective disclosure, established Mimblewimble, ring-signature or zero-knowledge constructions. The project will not invent custom cryptography merely to appear novel.

Cross-chain atomic swaps — adaptor signatures, hashed timelock contracts, scriptless scripts, Bitcoin transaction and timelock semantics, transaction malleability, refund paths, confirmation asymmetry, chain reorganisations, swap griefing, cross-chain privacy analysis, liquidity and counterparty discovery. The atomic-swap protocol has not yet been selected or specified.

Peer-to-peer and privacy networking — peer discovery, eclipse and Sybil resistance, transaction diffusion, Dandelion-style relay, Tor or I2P integration, traffic fingerprinting, denial-of-service resistance, network partition recovery.

Autonomous-agent wallet security — prompt injection, unrestricted machine-speed spending, compromised tools and plugins, malicious payment requests, key extraction, replayed intent, delegated signing authority, policy enforcement outside the language model, spending limits and revocable capabilities. A valid blockchain signature proves that a key authorised a transaction. It does not prove that an agent understood it or that its human operator intended it. This remains an open design problem.

Immediate Engineering Objectives

The first phase is deliberately narrow: reconcile current architectural contradictions; define explicit goals and non-goals; publish a formal threat model; select candidate consensus, transaction and privacy models; write architectural decision records; specify canonical block and transaction encodings; implement a minimal local node; run a reproducible three-node private devnet; simulate basic mining, propagation and chain reorganisations; prototype an interactive transaction handshake without claiming production privacy or security.

A public testnet will not be announced until the protocol has a coherent specification and the local implementation survives meaningful adversarial testing.

Fair-Launch Commitment

Cipher will have no pre-mine, no founder allocation, no developer allocation, no token sale, no protocol treasury, and no privileged mining period. If the network launches, founders, developers and the public will mine under the same published consensus rules.

Contributing does not create an entitlement to tokens, equity, governance power, future compensation or financial return. Development funding, should it exist, must remain separate from base-layer issuance — for example, transparent voluntary donations or independently funded grants denominated in Bitcoin or fiat, with no claim on future Cipher supply.

What Contributors Can Expect

All protocol work conducted in public. Permissively licensed open-source code. No requirement to purchase or hold a token. No token promotion or price discussion in engineering channels. Documented threat assumptions and unresolved risks. Technical disagreement welcomed. No claim that the whitepaper is authoritative over demonstrably better engineering. Recognition through public authorship and contribution history. An opportunity to shape a protocol from its earliest specification stage.

What We Need First

A small number of experienced contributors who can review and challenge the threat model, proof-of-work candidates, chain-bootstrapping security, the transaction model, privacy architecture, Bitcoin atomic-swap feasibility, and agent-wallet authority and containment.

A useful first contribution may be a written technical objection. Demonstrating that an assumption is false is more valuable than implementing it unquestioningly.

Cipher is not looking for people to endorse a finished design. It is looking for people capable of determining whether the design deserves to exist.

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2. Ten Communities for Serious Contributors

Ranked by technical relevance. Do not paste the same announcement into all ten. Each community expects participation in its own work before promotion.

1. Grin Forum and Grin GitHub

Closest cultural and architectural fit. Grin's technical community already discusses Mimblewimble, interactive transactions, privacy, proof of work and fair-launch principles. Approach: begin with a narrow design question about interactive transactions or atomic swaps. Do not open with 'join my new coin.'

2. Monero Research Lab

Focuses specifically on financial privacy research. Its research repository is public and explicitly supports collaboration. Approach: request criticism of a concrete privacy proposal. Monero contributors are unlikely to respond well to broad claims that Cipher will be anonymous or ungovernable.

3. Delving Bitcoin

High-signal forum for Bitcoin protocol design including P2P changes, wallet techniques and contract mechanisms. Approach: suitable for a carefully scoped post on Bitcoin to Cipher adaptor-signature swaps or cross-chain privacy — not a general recruitment advert.

4. Bitcoin Development Mailing List

Hosts protocol-level discussions including signature security, relay mechanisms and BIP proposals. Approach: only post after producing a technically serious atomic-swap or Bitcoin-interoperability proposal.

5. Bitcoin Core GitHub and #bitcoin-core-dev

Do not recruit through Bitcoin Core issues. Identify relevant public contributors from swap, P2P, wallet or cryptography work and contact them individually and respectfully.

6. Zcash Community Forum

Particularly relevant for zero-knowledge privacy, supply auditability, wallet privacy and network metadata. Approach: seek review of a specific privacy trade-off. Be transparent that Cipher is proof of work and does not share Zcash's governance structure.

7. IACR Cryptology ePrint

Not a recruitment board and should never receive a promotional post. Follow relevant authors and contact researchers only when you have a defined cryptographic question or preprint. Ask for paid review where possible.

8. RustCrypto and the Rust Cryptography Ecosystem

Useful for implementation review, safe API design, constant-time code and dependency selection. Open narrowly defined implementation discussions only after selecting established primitives.

9. Bitcoin Stack Exchange and Monero Stack Exchange

Ask precise, answerable questions. Recruitment posts are inappropriate. Strong questions can expose knowledgeable engineers whose public work you may later approach individually.

10. r/CryptoTechnology

Less selective but can produce useful adversarial feedback when posts are technical, non-promotional and explicit about unresolved problems. Publish a threat-model extract or one bounded architecture question.

Recommended Outreach Order

Publish the whitepaper, falsification document, threat model, architecture overview, five bounded design issues, and one minimal reproducible prototype. Then approach Grin and Monero contributors first. Contact Bitcoin and academic cryptography communities only when you have a specific technical object they can assess.

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3. Cold Outreach Message

Hello [name] — I am developing an early-stage open-source proof-of-work project called Cipher, intended as a private, non-custodial currency for autonomous-agent transactions.

There is no pre-mine, founder allocation, foundation, treasury or governance token. There is also no functioning network yet. We are still at the specification and threat-model stage, and I am trying to find people who will challenge the architecture rather than endorse it.

Your work on [specific contribution or project] appears directly relevant to [interactive transactions / privacy / consensus / atomic swaps]. Would you be willing to look at one narrowly defined design issue and tell me where the assumptions fail?

The current materials and issue are here: [link]

To be clear, there is no reserved token allocation or guaranteed compensation attached to contributing. If Cipher ever launches, everyone including founders and developers mines under the same publicly announced rules. Where funding becomes available, it will be separate from token issuance and disclosed openly.

No pressure to participate. Even a brief technical objection or a pointer to prior work we have missed would be genuinely useful.

Important Note on Framing

Do not lead developer recruitment with 'contributors can expect fair-launch mining.' That can sound like deferred token compensation or an invitation to speculate. Lead with the engineering problem and place the fair-launch policy under what contributors should not expect: no allocation, no privileged access, no guaranteed reward — only equal access to public mining if a network is eventually launched.

That framing is more credible, legally safer and more likely to earn respect from experienced protocol engineers.

Alternative Shorter Outreach Tone

For engineers who may find a longer message too formal, a shorter peer-to-peer version:

Hi [name], I have been following your work on [project] — specifically your approach to [specific technical detail]. I am building a fair-launch proof-of-work blockchain called Cipher designed for AI agent commerce. No pre-mine, no token pump, pure protocol. I am looking for someone with your background in [specific skill] to sanity-check the consensus architecture. If you are open to a technical critique I would love to share the whitepaper and threat model. No commitments — just looking for eyes from someone who understands the trade-offs in distributed systems.